

Chapter 5

Spatial Electron Distributions

Some of this is listed in tables in Foot [2]. Please contact Prof. Campbell if you find any errors.

5.1 Wavefunctions

The wavefunctions are most-commonly expressed as complex eigenstates of L_z or as real-valued functions that point along directions in space. The complex ones are typically preferred in physics, and are the energy eigenstates of gas-phase atoms, with or without a static, uniform magnetic field. The real-valued functions are typically preferred in chemistry, where symmetry breaking from chemical bonding makes the energy eigenstates more-closely resemble the real-valued functions.

First, we can write some of the lowest-energy complex wavefunctions. The general case is given by

$$\begin{aligned}\psi_{n,L,M}(\mathbf{r}) &= \langle \mathbf{r} | \psi_{n,L,M} \rangle \\ &= \sqrt{\left(\frac{2Z}{na_0}\right)^{3+2L} \frac{(n-L-1)!}{(n+L)! 2n}} e^{-Zr/(na_0)} r^L \mathcal{L}_{n-L-1}^{2L+1}\left[\frac{2Z}{na_0}r\right] Y_{LM}(\omega)\end{aligned}\tag{5.1}$$

where $\mathcal{L}_n^a[x]$ is the generalized Laguerre polynomial in x (we are using the convention adopted by, for example, Mathematica).

orbital	$\langle \mathbf{r} \psi_{n,L,M} \rangle$
$1s \ (M_L = 0)$	$\sqrt{\frac{Z^3}{\pi a_0^3}} e^{-Zr/a_0}$
$2s \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} \left(r - 2\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) e^{-Zr/(2a_0)}$
$2p \ (M_L = \pm 1)$	$\mp \frac{1}{8} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{\pi a_0^5}} r e^{-Zr/(2a_0)} \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi}$
$2p \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} r e^{-Zr/(2a_0)} \cos(\theta)$
$3s \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{2}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{3\pi a_0^7}} \left(r^2 - 9\frac{a_0}{Z} r + \frac{27}{2} \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3p \ (M_L = \pm 1)$	$\mp \frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} \left(r - 6\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) r e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi}$
$3p \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} \left(r - 6\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) r e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \cos(\theta)$
$3d \ (M_L = \pm 2)$	$\frac{1}{162} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} r^2 e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \sin^2(\theta) e^{\pm i2\phi}$
$3d \ (M_L = \pm 1)$	$\mp \frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} r^2 e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \sin(\theta) \cos(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi}$
$3d \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{6\pi a_0^7}} r^2 e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} (3 \cos^2(\theta) - 1)$
$4s \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{1536} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^3 - 24\frac{a_0}{Z} r^2 + 144 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 r - 192 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^3 \right) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4p \ (M_L = \pm 1)$	$\mp \frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{10\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^2 - 20\frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) r e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi}$
$4p \ (M_L = 0)$	$\frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^2 - 20\frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) r e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \cos(\theta)$
$4d \ (M_L = \pm 2)$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{6\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) r^2 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \sin^2(\theta) e^{\pm i2\phi}$
$4d \ (M_L = \pm 1)$	$\mp \frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{6\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) r^2 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \sin(\theta) \cos(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi}$

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{orbital} & \quad \langle \mathbf{r} | \psi_{n,L,M} \rangle \\
4d \ (M_L = 0) & \quad \frac{1}{3072} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) r^2 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} (3 \cos^2(\theta) - 1) \\
4f \ (M_L = \pm 3) & \quad \mp \frac{1}{6144} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} r^3 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \sin^3(\theta) e^{\pm i 3\phi} \\
4f \ (M_L = \pm 2) & \quad \frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{6\pi a_0^9}} r^3 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \sin^2(\theta) \cos(\theta) e^{\pm i 2\phi} \\
4f \ (M_L = \pm 1) & \quad \mp \frac{1}{2048} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{15\pi a_0^9}} r^3 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} (5 \cos^2(\theta) - 1) \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i \phi} \\
4f \ (M_L = 0) & \quad \frac{1}{3072} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5\pi a_0^9}} r^3 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} (5 \cos^2(\theta) - 3) \cos(\theta)
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
R_{n,l} & \quad \text{radial wavefunction} \\
R_{1,0}(r) & = 2 \sqrt{\frac{Z^3}{a_0^3}} e^{-Zr/a_0} \\
R_{2,0}(r) & = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2a_0^5}} \left(r - 2 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) e^{-Zr/(2a_0)} \\
R_{2,1}(r) & = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{6a_0^5}} r e^{-Zr/(2a_0)} \\
R_{3,0}(r) & = \frac{4}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{3a_0^7}} \left(r^2 - 9 \frac{a_0}{Z} r + \frac{27}{2} \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \\
R_{3,1}(r) & = \frac{2}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{3a_0^7}} r \left(r - 6 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \\
R_{3,2}(r) & = \frac{2}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{15a_0^7}} r^2 e^{-Zr/(3a_0)} \\
R_{4,0}(r) & = \frac{1}{768} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{a_0^9}} \left(r^3 - 24 \frac{a_0}{Z} r^2 + 144 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 r - 192 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^3 \right) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \\
R_{4,1}(r) & = \frac{1}{256} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{15a_0^9}} r \left(r^2 - 20 \frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \\
R_{4,2}(r) & = \frac{1}{768} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5a_0^9}} r^2 \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)} \\
R_{4,3}(r) & = \frac{1}{768} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{35a_0^9}} r^3 e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}
\end{aligned}$$

The spherical harmonics, $Y_{L,M_L}(\boldsymbol{\omega})$, up to $L = 4$ (which is to say for s, p ,

d , f , and g states) are given below.

$$\begin{aligned}
Y_{0,0}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\pi}} \\
Y_{1,\pm 1}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{3}{2\pi}} \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi} \\
Y_{1,0}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{3}{\pi}} \cos(\theta) \\
Y_{2,\pm 2}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{15}{2\pi}} \sin^2(\theta) e^{\pm i2\phi} \\
Y_{2,\pm 1}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{\frac{15}{2\pi}} \cos(\theta) \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi} \\
Y_{2,0}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{5}{\pi}} (3 \cos^2(\theta) - 1) \\
Y_{3,\pm 3}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{1}{8} \sqrt{\frac{35}{\pi}} \sin^3(\theta) e^{\pm i3\phi} \\
Y_{3,\pm 2}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{105}{2\pi}} \cos(\theta) \sin^2(\theta) e^{\pm i2\phi} \\
Y_{3,\pm 1}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{1}{8} \sqrt{\frac{21}{\pi}} (5 \cos^2(\theta) - 1) \sin(\theta) e^{\pm i\phi} \\
Y_{3,0}(\omega) &= \frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{7}{\pi}} (5 \cos^2(\theta) - 3) \cos(\theta) \\
Y_{4,\pm 4}(\omega) &= \frac{3}{16} \sqrt{\frac{35}{2\pi}} \sin^4(\theta) e^{\pm i4\phi} \\
Y_{4,\pm 3}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{3}{8} \sqrt{\frac{35}{\pi}} \sin^3(\theta) \cos(\theta) e^{\pm i3\phi} \\
Y_{4,\pm 2}(\omega) &= \frac{3}{8} \sqrt{\frac{5}{2\pi}} \sin^2(\theta) (7 \cos^2(\theta) - 1) e^{\pm i2\phi} \\
Y_{4,\pm 1}(\omega) &= \mp \frac{3}{8} \sqrt{\frac{5}{\pi}} \sin(\theta) (7 \cos^3(\theta) - 3 \cos(\theta)) e^{\pm i\phi} \\
Y_{4,0}(\omega) &= \frac{3}{16\sqrt{\pi}} (35 \cos^4(\theta) - 30 \cos^2(\theta) + 3)
\end{aligned}$$

From the spherical harmonics, it is possible to define analogous functions that are real, and these end up being preferred in chemistry. The normalized tesseral harmonics are given by

$$Z_{L,M}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) \equiv \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left(Y_{L,-M}(\boldsymbol{\omega}) + (-1)^M Y_{L,M}(\boldsymbol{\omega}) \right) \quad (5.2)$$

$$Z_{L,0}(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) \equiv Y_{L,0}(\boldsymbol{\omega}) \quad (5.3)$$

$$Z_{L,M}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) \equiv \frac{i}{\sqrt{2}} \left(Y_{L,-M}(\boldsymbol{\omega}) - (-1)^M Y_{L,M}(\boldsymbol{\omega}) \right) \quad (5.4)$$

where $M \geq 0$. Here, the “c” and “s” labels denote cosine and sine (of ϕ), respectively, and the middle line is to be used when $M = 0$. These are normalized to $\int d^2\boldsymbol{\omega} Z_{L',M'}^{t'} Z_{L,M}^t = \delta_{L'L} \delta_{M'M} \delta_{t't}$ where $t, t' \in \{c, s\}$ (or nothing for $M = 0$).

The tesseral harmonics vanish on $L - M$ half-cones of rotation about the z axis (in a globe-surface model, $L - M$ parallels of latitude) and M planes that contain the z axis (M great circles of longitude). These planes intersect one another at locally-right angles on the surface of a sphere.

We can calculate a few of these to get a grasp of what spatial distributions are described by them. For this, we will make use of the Cartesian variables via substitution of

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{x}{r} &= \sin(\theta) \cos(\phi) \\ \frac{y}{r} &= \sin(\theta) \sin(\phi) \\ \frac{z}{r} &= \cos(\theta). \end{aligned} \quad (5.5)$$

These linear combinations give

$$\begin{aligned}
Z_{0,0}(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\pi}} \\
Z_{1,1}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{3}{\pi}} \frac{x}{r} \\
Z_{1,1}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{3}{\pi}} \frac{y}{r} \\
Z_{1,0}(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{3}{\pi}} \frac{z}{r} \\
Z_{2,2}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{15}{\pi}} (x^2 - y^2) \frac{1}{r^2} \\
Z_{2,2}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{15}{\pi}} \frac{xy}{r^2} \\
Z_{2,1}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{15}{\pi}} \frac{zx}{r^2} \\
Z_{2,1}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{15}{\pi}} \frac{zy}{r^2} \\
Z_{2,0}(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{5}{\pi}} (3z^2 - r^2) \frac{1}{r^2} \\
Z_{3,3}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{35}{2\pi}} (x^3 - 3xy^2) \frac{1}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,3}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{35}{2\pi}} (3x^2y - y^3) \frac{1}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,2}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{105}{\pi}} (x^2 - y^2) \frac{z}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,2}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{105}{\pi}} \frac{xyz}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,1}^c(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{21}{2\pi}} (5z^2 - r^2) \frac{x}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,1}^s(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{21}{2\pi}} (5z^2 - r^2) \frac{y}{r^3} \\
Z_{3,0}(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_r) &= \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{\frac{7}{\pi}} (5z^2 - 3r^2) \frac{z}{r^3}
\end{aligned}$$

and so forth. These lead to the Cartesian-friendly, real-valued versions of the hydrogenic wavefunctions:

orbital	$\langle \mathbf{r} \psi \rangle$
$1s$	$\sqrt{\frac{Z^3}{\pi a_0^3}} e^{-Zr/a_0}$
$2s$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} \left(r - 2\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) e^{-Zr/(2a_0)}$
$2p_x$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} x e^{-Zr/(2a_0)}$
$2p_y$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} y e^{-Zr/(2a_0)}$
$2p_z$	$\frac{1}{4} \sqrt{\frac{Z^5}{2\pi a_0^5}} z e^{-Zr/(2a_0)}$
$3s$	$\frac{2}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{3\pi a_0^7}} \left(r^2 - 9\frac{a_0}{Z}r + \frac{27}{2} \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3p_x$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} \left(r - 6\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) x e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3p_y$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} \left(r - 6\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) y e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3p_z$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} \left(r - 6\frac{a_0}{Z} \right) z e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3d_{3z^2-r^2}$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{6\pi a_0^7}} (3z^2 - r^2) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3d_{zx}$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} zx e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3d_{zy}$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} zy e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3d_{xy}$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{2Z^7}{\pi a_0^7}} xy e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$
$3d_{x^2-y^2}$	$\frac{1}{81} \sqrt{\frac{Z^7}{2\pi a_0^7}} (x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(3a_0)}$

orbital	$\langle \mathbf{r} \psi \rangle$
$4s$	$\frac{1}{1536} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^3 - 24 \frac{a_0}{Z} r^2 + 144 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 r - 192 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^3 \right) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4p_x$	$\mp \frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^2 - 20 \frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) x e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4p_y$	$\mp \frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^2 - 20 \frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) y e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4p_z$	$\mp \frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{5\pi a_0^9}} \left(r^2 - 20 \frac{a_0}{Z} r + 80 \left(\frac{a_0}{Z} \right)^2 \right) z e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4d_{3z^2-r^2}$	$\frac{1}{3072} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) (3z^2 - r^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4d_{zx}$	$\frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{3\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) zx e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4d_{zy}$	$\frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{3\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) zy e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4d_{xy}$	$\frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{3\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) xy e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4d_{x^2-y^2}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{3\pi a_0^9}} \left(r - 12 \frac{a_0}{Z} \right) (x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{xyz}$	$\frac{1}{512} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} xyz e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{z(x^2-y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{\pi a_0^9}} z (x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{y(3x^2-y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{6\pi a_0^9}} y (3x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{x(x^2-3y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{6\pi a_0^9}} x (x^2 - 3y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{x(4z^2-x^2-y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{10\pi a_0^9}} x (4z^2 - x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{y(4z^2-x^2-y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{10\pi a_0^9}} y (4z^2 - x^2 - y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$
$4f_{z(2z^2-3x^2-3y^2)}$	$\frac{1}{1024} \sqrt{\frac{Z^9}{15\pi a_0^9}} z (2z^2 - 3x^2 - 3y^2) e^{-Zr/(4a_0)}$